

Yogesh KULKARNI

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research develops post-training methods for video-language models that reason over long-horizon spatial, temporal, and audio-visual content. I study preference alignment and reinforcement learning with structured signals for data-efficient multimodal reasoning, including adaptive reasoning and proactive decision-making in continuous egocentric streams.

EDUCATION

May 2028	Arizona State University, TEMPE, AZ, USA
Aug 2024	Ph.D. in Computer Science Advisor : Dr. Pooyan Fazli
May 2024	University of Southern California, Los ANGELES, CA, USA
Aug 2022	Master of Science in Computer Science
Jul 2022	Pune Institute of Computer Technology, PUNE, India
Aug 2018	Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- [1] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “AVATAR : Reinforcement Learning to See, Hear, and Reason Over Video.” *IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR 2026)*. [PDF]
- [2] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “EgoVITA : Learning to Plan and Verify for Egocentric Video Reasoning.” *European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV 2026)*. [PDF]
- [3] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “Video-FLAIR : Not Whether to Reason, But How.” *arXiv preprint, 2026*. [PDF]
- [4] Chaoyu Li, **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “ReGATE : Learning Faster and Better with Fewer Tokens in MLLMs.” *Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL Main 2026)*. [PDF]
- [5] Chaoyu Li, Xiaoyi Gu, **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Eun Woo Im, Mohammadmahdi Honarmand, et al. “Video Generation Models : A Survey of Post-Training and Alignment.” *Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR 2026)*. [Paper]
- [6] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “VideoPASTA : 7K Preference Pairs That Matter for Video-LLM Alignment.” *Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP Main 2025)*. [PDF]
- [7] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “VideoSAVi : Self-Aligned Video Language Models without Human Supervision.” *Conference on Language Modeling (COLM 2025)*. [PDF]

EXPERIENCE

Present May 2026	Adobe Research, SAN JOSE, CA, USA <i>Research Scientist Intern</i> Mentor : Dr. Puneet Mathur ➢ Developed proactive reasoning omni models that decide when and what to say during lecture videos trained with GRPO and on-policy self-distillation on a reason-then-speak objective.
Present Aug 2024	People and Robots Laboratory (PeRL), ARIZONA STATE UNIVERSITY, Tempe, AZ <i>Graduate Researcher</i> Advisor : Dr. Pooyan Fazli ➢ Video reasoning models (CVPR’26), egocentric and procedural video understanding (ECCV’26), video-language alignment (EMNLP’25, COLM’25), and efficient training for multimodal LLMs (ACL’26).
Aug 2023 May 2023	Nokia Bell Labs, NEW PROVIDENCE, NJ, USA <i>Research Scientist Intern</i> Mentor : Dr. Thomas Woo ➢ Implemented automatic model parallelism for GPT-3 and LLaMA, increasing training throughput by 15% across heterogeneous clusters. Designed communication- and compute-efficient inter-node pipeline parallelism for geo-distributed GPUs.
Mar 2024 Jan 2023	USC Institute for Creative Technologies, Los ANGELES, CA, USA <i>Graduate Research Assistant</i> Advisor : Dr. Meida Chen ➢ Built a 3D style transfer pipeline with ViT, CLIP, and Gaussian Splatting for text-guided point-cloud coloring. Explored DDPMs and GANs with PointNet, KPConv, and SparseUNet for 3D colorization.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer : NeurIPS, CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, AAAI, ACL Rolling Review (ARR), TPAMI, and TMLR.